



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Abiding Savior Academy
School Website: <https://abidingacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Abiding Savior Academy (Sioux Falls, SD, 57103) presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Public materials from the school emphasize a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integration of a Biblical worldview across disciplines, explicit Great Books and literature study, and a pedagogy that blends memorization, chanting, narration, and Socratic-style inquiry as students progress. The school also foregrounds formation of virtue and character, liturgical/community practices (notably all-school chapels), and a strong partnership with parents as co-educators. Taken together, these signals indicate a CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories of evaluation.

Key directions observed across sources include: a mission that centers on shaping affections toward truth, goodness, and beauty in a God-centered framework; a curriculum with Trivium foundations and Great Books; layered pedagogy from memory-oriented grammar work to rhetoric and public speaking; teachers and faith leaders modeled as living exemplars; and active parental partnerships with opportunities for ongoing formation. Evidence includes explicit statements of classical aims, references to the Trivium and Great Books, and concrete practices such as chapel worship and liturgical integration. See cited materials for examples (e.g., Core Values and Mission statements, Trivium-era language, Great Books examples, and chapel-related practices). The knowledge-lexicon confirms the alignment by listing typical positive indicators (truth, virtue, liturgy, great books, scholé, etc.) and negative indicators to watch for (e.g., overly secular modern workplace emphasis) that, in the Abiding Savior materials, are not present in a negative sense.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Core values include Christian, classical, wisdom, virtue, family, and reasoning, signaling a clearly religious and metaphysical basis aligned with classical aims. - Mission statement emphasizes shaping affections to love truth, goodness, and beauty for Gospel-centered disciples, integrating theology with education. - Public materials describe Biblical worldview integration across curriculum and daily life, including references to God as Creator and to biblical verses as touchpoints in science, math, and literature. - Communal liturgical practices are evident (e.g., All-School Chapel scheduled events) and pastoral involvement noted. - Language around God, theology, worship, and sacred texts appears throughout source materials (Genesis 1:1, Psalm 139:13, etc.).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, classical, wisdom, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, chapel, worship, sacred, gospel, biblical worldview, Logos, imago Dei (where invoked by context), wonder. - Negative keywords: absent in school materials (no signals of relativism, secular humanism, values clarification, or a purely secular framework). - Estimated balance: Pre-

dominantly positive keywords with little to no negative indicators observed in the materials. Approximate positive/negative keyword presence: high positive signal, 0 negative signals in the public materials reviewed; effectively 100% positive among the indicators present in the texts.

Why this rating - The materials show a transcendental orientation toward truth, goodness, beauty in a theologically grounded frame, with liturgical community practices and explicit Biblical integration. The presence of liturgical life (chapel), Christian theology, and a biblical worldview, paired with classical lexicon, strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category. See core values and chapel references noted above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes formation and virtue (not merely job-readiness): “shape the affections of students to love truth, goodness, and beauty so that they become confident disciples who impact their world for Jesus Christ”. - Public statements frame education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not solely information or workforce preparation. Language about life preparation and lifelong learning appears in materials (e.g., “good education prepares students not just for college but for life”). - Claims about truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable align with classical telos and paideia aims (formation of humane and virtuous persons).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful, classical mission, great conversation, moral imagination, liberal education, scholé, contemplation. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none (no emphasis on 21st-century skills, workforce-prep-only framing, or career-readiness as the primary aim appears in the public materials). - Estimated balance: Strong positive presence with little to no negative signals; roughly 100% positive among the relevant indicators in the texts.

Why this rating - The school’s stated purpose centers on virtue formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, with a formation-based aim aligned to classical paideia rather than merely job-readiness. The public statements about life-long learning, virtue, and a classical mission anchor this category as CLASSICAL. See mission and formation language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear Trivium structure: grammar (K–5), logic (6–8), rhetoric (9–12) described in multiple sources, including curriculum maps and program descriptions. - Great Books and primary sources are integral to the curriculum (e.g., Beowulf, The Odyssey, The Iliad, Paradise Lost, etc.), with explicit lists in the School of Logic and School of Rhetoric materials. - History studied across disciplines; references to Western civilization, salvation history, chronology, and integration with other subjects (e.g., Bible readings in literature) are present. - Latin and classical languages are mentioned as components of the curriculum and as affirming classical education (Latin roots referenced). - Emphasis on wonder, memorization, and cultivation of the “Great Conversation” through classical texts and methods is evident in various school pages.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classics, Homer/Plato/Augustine/Shakespeare, Latin, Greek, history, Western civilization, memory work, narration, dictation, chants, hymnody, sacred art. - Negative keywords present: minimal signals (negative lists focus on social studies as replacement for history or project-based learning dominance, which are not reflected as guiding practices in these materials). - Estimated balance: Strong positive keyword presence with no explicit negative indicators in the materials; approximate 8–12 positive keywords observed vs 0 explicit negatives.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly framed around the Trivium, Great Books, and classical studies with historic texts, languages, and a history-centered approach, matching CLASSICAL criteria. See Trivium reference and Great Books examples.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy includes both contemplative/restful elements and rigorous engagement: “Layered Learning” that begins with memory-building in the Grammar stage and progresses toward questions and articulation in Logic and Rhetoric stages, with an emphasis on wonder and biblical worldview throughout. - Lower school engages in singing, chanting, memory work, and regular review to deepen memory and delight (evidence of ritualized, contemplative pedagogy). - Upper school emphasizes Socratic-like discussion, seminars, debates, and development of rhetoric and speaking ability (Rhetoric School description, The Eloquent Expression of Ideas). - The rhetoric stage emphasizes extensive practice in expressing knowledge and defending theses, with a view toward public speaking and persuasive communication, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: layered learning, scholé, contemplation, wonder, memory, narration, recitation, chanting, singing, Socratic/seminar-style discussions, rhetoric, speech, declamation, oratory, debate, memory work, liturgical calendar integration. - Negative keywords present: the public materials do not display the typical negative indicators (e.g., project-based-only, experiential learning emphasis, or “guide-on-the-side” avoidance of memory-based pedagogy) in the pathways described. - Estimated balance: Strong positive presence; negligible to no negative indicators in the materials (roughly 8–12 positive signals vs 0 explicit negative signals).

Why this rating - Pedagogical practices align with classical methods: memorization and chant in early years; Socratic/seminar-style inquiry and rhetoric in later years; and a deliberate emphasis on forming virtue and understanding through classical texts and disciplined study. See Layered Learning and rhetoric-focused pages for specifics.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as model teachers, mentors, and living exemplars who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; pastors and staff are highlighted as integral to formation and to modeling Christ-like character. - The living curriculum concept is suggested by the way faculty are positioned as “the core” of school culture and by emphasis on teacher leadership and discipleship, with (implicitly) a culture of collegiality in which teachers and students learn together. - A portrait of what a teacher should be and what a student should be is echoed in the public materials, including the emphasis on character formation and pastoral leadership in the school community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, teachers as lifelong learners, seminars for faculty. - Negative keywords present: minimal signals of negative faculty practices (the lexicon’s negative indicators such as “facilitators,” “guides on the side,” or “certification-driven jargon” are not evident in the Abiding Savior materials). - Estimated balance: Predominantly positive keywords with little to no negative indicators; effectively a strong CLASSICAL signal for this category.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on virtuous, knowledgeable teachers; the idea of teachers as living exemplars, mentors, and the core of the school’s mission fits CLASSICAL entrepreneurially (teacher-centered, virtue-formation-focused) pedagogy. See faculty language in the materials cited above.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Strong partnership with parents is stated explicitly; parents are described as co-teachers with school teachers and are engaged in formation via the website, book studies, and gatherings. - The school provides multiple channels for parental involvement (Parent Portal, opportunities for engagement, and a culture of parental participation in formation and school events). - Open-campus philosophy and ease of parental visits is indicated; address and contact information reinforce accessibility to families and prospective families. - The school’s published materials reference parental involvement, family liturgy alignment, and home-based catechesis as part of a classical education ecosystem (e.g., “household worship,” family participation).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, hospitality, parent covenant, household worship, family liturgy alignment, family participation. - Negative keywords present: The materials do not reflect consumer-language signals or a “parent-as-customer” framing; rather they emphasize ongoing formation and partnership. - Estimated balance: Strong positive keywords with no notable negative signals; effectively CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present parents as essential collaborators in education, with explicit formation opportunities and open access to events and learning processes, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for community involvement. See parent-focused materials and partnerships described above.

Overall Aggregate Assessment - Category-by-category ratings indicate CLASSICAL in all six categories. Aggregating across categories, Abiding Savior Academy (Sioux Falls, SD, 57103) is CLASSICAL in its approach to religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose and goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the current CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. If desired, the school could further strengthen the CLASSICAL signal by explicitly labeling certain pedagogical practices with canonical classical terms (e.g., more explicit references to Socratic seminars or “Great Books” as a formal phrase in more pages) to ensure visitors immediately recognize the full breadth of classical terms and ensure consistent usage across all program descriptions. This is optional and would serve to reinforce clarity rather than to alter the existing CLASSICAL status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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